Using Open Source Libraries for Sentiment Analysis on Social Media

Social media plays a crucial role in the formation of public opinion. Sentiment analysis, also known as opinion mining, is the processing of natural language, text analysis and computational linguistics to extract subjective information from source material. Sentimental analysis is used in poll result prediction, marketing and customer service.

Sentiment analysis is widely used by research scholars and others. In this approach, there are a number of tools and technologies available for fetching live data sets, tweets, emotional attributes, etc. Using these tools, real-time tweets and messages can be extracted from Twitter, Facebook, Whats App and many other social media portals. This article presents the fetching of live tweets from Twitter using Python programming.

The emotional attributes of Internet users on social media portals can be analysed, and certain conclusions arrived at and predictions made using this method. Let us suppose that we want to evaluate the overall cumulative score of a celebrity. For this, Python or PHP based programming scripts can fetch live tweets about that celebrity from Twitter. After that, using natural language processing toolkits, the fetched data in the form of tweets or messages can be analysed and the popularity of that particular person or movie or celebrity can be more accurately assessed.

The following are the statistical reports from *InternetLiveStats.com* and *Statista.com* about the real time data on social media and related Web portals.

Around 350 million tweets flow daily from more than 500 million accounts on Twitter. Around 571 new websites are hosted every minute on the World Wide Web. There are more than 5 billion users on their mobile phones concurrently.